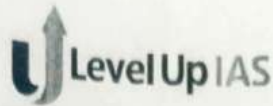


Q.6b (15 marks): Kardiner Idea of Culture and Personality School - deep-seated psychological motivations



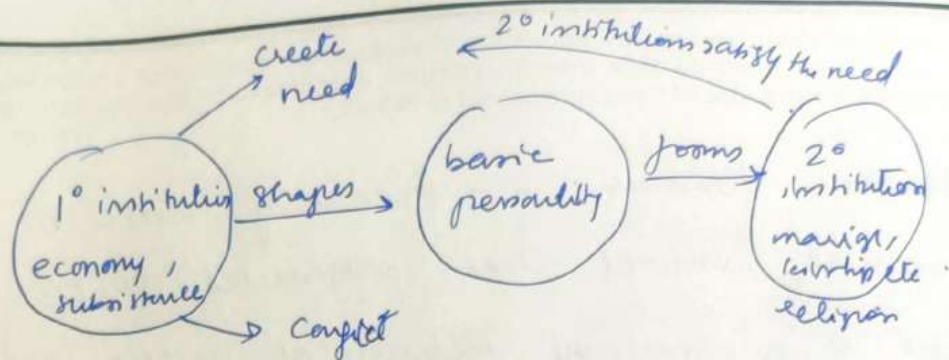
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7.b) The study of Basic Personality allows us to explore the deep-seated psychological motivations and conflicts that underlie cultural phenomena." Discuss in view of Abraham Kardiner's Idea of Culture Personality School. (15 marks)

Abraham Kardiner, a proponent of culture personality school has postulated that there is a mutual influence of culture and personality ^{on} with each other.

He along with Ralph Linton in his book "Psychological Frontiers of Society" presented the idea of Basic Personality which he identifies as the common characteristics, attitudes & beliefs shaped by people of a culture owing to their common socialisation practices.

He gives a psychodynamic approach to culture change where in he divides cultural institutions into primary & secondary and opines that the primary institutions tend to shape basic personality of an individual which eventually affects the secondary institution.



He validates his theory through fieldwork among Marquesans.

1° institution	basic personality	2° institution
food shortage polyandry	conflictual maternal neglect => unstable	Vébinitti: viewing women as seducers who kill eventually

Social change among Tanele community:

Need to inherit land from father → father son bond → ancestors as benevolent spirits

economy change to wet rice cultivation → no longer need to inherit land

⇒ father son hostility → ancestors as malevolent spirits

Criticism :

- 1) The existence of multiple personalities & hence couldn't explain cultural variation
- 2) Not based on empirical facts
- 3) Over generalisations
- 4) Not applicable to modern societies which witnessed multiple migration.

Relevance :

- 1) The concept of basic personality used in National Character Studies.
- 2) Diplomacy b/w nations
- 3) For market study in MNCs to understand consumer behavior.

In summary, Kardiner's proposition of culture & personality mutually influencing each other is widely accepted & he is credited for his interdisciplinary approach.